

Dekel Riess

Game Designer — Systems, Economy & Progression

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Based in Israel · EU citizen — authorized to work across the EU, no sponsorship required · Open to relocation & remote

PROFILE

Systems-focused game designer studying at Tiltan College of Visual Design and Communication. I design the mechanics, economies, and progression that make a game click — and I code my own systems in C#/Unity, so every design is tested in a real build, not just on paper. Five finished games across five genres — including a shipped physical board game — built with playtest-driven iteration and full design documentation.

CORE SKILLS

Design: Systems Design · Game Mechanics · Economy & Balance · Progression · Level Design · UX · Playtesting & Iteration · Game Design Documents (GDDs)

Engines & Code: Unity · C# · MonoGame · Android

Tools: Figma · Git · Aseprite · Tiled · Adobe Premiere Pro

Languages: Hebrew (Native) · English (Fluent) · Japanese (Conversational)

SELECTED PROJECTS

Dekelatro — Poker Roguelike

Solo · C# · Graded 100/100

Engineered from scratch in ~2,250 lines of C# with no engine or card library: a polymorphic joker system, a scoring pipeline, and a weighted-RNG shop, plus a full economy rebalance and original content. Built as the Introduction to C# final project.

Trials of the Dungeon — Co-op Board Game

Game Designer & Co-Director

Cooperative dungeon-crawl shipped as a physical product. Designed the combat, economy, and progression; wrote and laid out the full 14-page rulebook; ran 5 structured playtests and rebalanced core systems from the data. Presented to a judging panel.

TiltanTale — Action RPG

Lead Gameplay Designer · C#/MonoGame

Undertale-inspired RPG with an engine-less, code-authored battle framework and 15+ hand-built boss encounters, each with unique attack patterns. Two-person team; released on itch.io.

Brave the Wilderness — Mobile Survival

Lead Designer · Unity/Android

Merge-driven survival game built on a single “two-in, one-out” rule that scales into a 117-item, 5-tier crafting economy. Owned progression, economy, and balance. Course final project; playable Android build.

Dice Bound — Idle Battler (GDD)

Lead Designer · Design Complete

Party-based idle battler with dice roles, spell synergies, and a prestige loop. Led design on a 3-person team; wrote the full GDD and shelved the project after a team post-mortem.

EXPERIENCE

Community Manager & Game Designer — Yourpixel

2017 – 2020

Ran a Minecraft server end-to-end; designed game modes and quests for retention and recruited/led a content team. Grew concurrent players from ~30 to ~200.

Content Creator — YouTube

2012 – 2023

Scripted, filmed, and edited long-form video for 20,000+ subscribers — the foundation of the trailer and devlog work I do today.

Fighter Jet Technician — Israeli Air Force (Reservist)

2020 – Present

Aircraft maintenance and troubleshooting under strict safety protocols. Squadron Excellence Certificate, 2021.

Aircraft Mechanic — El Al Airlines

2023 – 2024

Maintenance and inspections across four commercial aircraft types under tight international turnaround windows.

EDUCATION

Game Design & Development — Tiltan College of Visual Design and Communication

2025 – 2028 (Expected)

Coursework: C#, Object-Oriented Programming, Game Design.

Full Bagrut (Israeli Matriculation) — Ankori North High School

2015 – 2018